The RRB Group D & Level-1 Playbook 2026-27

Four gates, the exact standards, and the arithmetic nobody explains.

22,195
posts in the last cycle

3x
PET shortlist against vacancies

35 kg
carried 100 m, one chance

4:15
for 1000 m, one chance

Computer Based Test | Physical Efficiency Test | Document Verification | Medical

UPDATED 13 NOVEMBER 2026

Built from CEN 09/2025, the Railway Board Annual Calendar 2026-27 and the Indian Railway Medical Manual. Every figure traceable. Sources listed inside.

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Read this first

This is a process book, not a coaching book.

There is no shortage of mock tests for the RRB Level-1 examination. What is missing is a straight account of how the recruitment actually works: what each of the four stages is worth, how the shortlists are built, what the physical and medical standards say in words rather than table cells, and which decisions you cannot undo.

That is what this book is. Twelve parts, six worksheets, and a sources list at the back naming every document the facts came from.

Three things it is not. It is not affiliated with Indian Railways, any Railway Recruitment Board or any Railway Recruitment Cell. It is not a substitute for the Centralised Employment Notice: the CEN is the legal document, and where this book and the live CEN disagree, the CEN wins. And it does not carry predictions of dates or vacancy numbers, because those are not knowable until a notification is published.

How to use it

Find your row in the table on the next page and start there. If you are on the PET shortlist, Part 7 is urgent and everything else can wait a week. If you are waiting for the next notification, read Parts 3, 4 and 5 before you touch a syllabus, because the choices in the application form decide which medical standard you will be judged against a year from now.

> A note on figures. Every number in this book is traceable to a named document: the CEN 09/2025 notification, the Railway Board's annual recruitment calendar for 2026-27, the Indian Railway Medical Manual, or the 8th Central Pay Commission's own website. Where something is an expectation rather than a fact, it says so. Sources are listed at the back.

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The six worksheets at the back are designed to be written on. Print pages for the eligibility check, the application checklist, the document file and the ten-week PET log, and keep them where you will see them.

PART 1

Where you stand on 13 November 2026

Two recruitment cycles are running at once, and they need different things from you.

The Railway Recruitment Boards declared the Computer Based Test result for CEN 09/2025 today. Zone-wise shortlists for the Physical Efficiency Test are out. At the same time, the next Level-1 cycle is sitting on the Railway Board's calendar for the October to December 2026 quarter, with the draft notification targeted for October 2026 and no notification on any RRB website as of this morning.

So there are two audiences reading this, and the first job is to work out which one you are. Read the table, find your row, and go straight to the part that matters to you.

	Cycle A: CEN 09/2025	Cycle B: Level-1 2026-27
Status today	CBT result and PET shortlists declared 13 Nov 2026	Not yet notified. Draft CEN target was October 2026
Posts	22,195 Level-1 posts	Not announced. Press reports suggest around 30,000, unconfirmed
Application window	31 Jan 2026 to 2 Mar 2026, closed	Will open with the CEN, expected weeks away
Stages left	PET, Document Verification, Medical Examination	All four stages
What you do now	Go to Part 7. Start the carry and run work this week	Go to Parts 3, 4 and 5, then start Part 6 and Part 7

What is actually confirmed, and what is only expectation

It is worth being strict about this, because the ecosystem around railway recruitment is loud and loose with dates.

- **Confirmed.** CEN 09/2025 offered 22,195 posts in Level 1 of the 7th CPC pay matrix, at an initial pay of Rs. 18,000, open to candidates aged 18 to 33 who have passed Class 10 or hold an ITI or a National Apprenticeship Certificate from NCVT.
- **Confirmed.** The Ministry of Railways issued its annual recruitment calendar for 2026-27 on 12 December 2025. It places Level-1 posts in the October to December 2026 quarter, with vacancy assessment counted up to 31 December 2027 and a draft CEN proposal targeted for October 2026. RRB Chandigarh is the nodal board for this category.
- **Confirmed.** As of today the RRB notice boards list only CEN 01/2026, Assistant Loco Pilot, under the 2026 calendar. There is no Level-1 CEN for 2026-27 published.
- **Expectation, not fact.** The figure of roughly 30,000 posts circulating in the press comes from reported internal estimates, not from a notification. Treat it as a hint about scale, never as a number to plan around.
- **Expectation, not fact.** Any date you see for the 2026-27 application window or CBT, on any website, is a guess until the PDF appears on an RRB domain.

> The one rule that keeps you out of trouble: a date is real only when it is inside a CEN PDF hosted on an official RRB website. Everything else, including this book's summary of the calendar, is context.

The single number that decides everything

Three. For every community-wise vacancy, three candidates are called to the Physical Efficiency Test. The test is qualifying, so clearing it adds nothing to your score. Document Verification is then held at one candidate per vacancy.

At 22,195 posts, that means around 66,585 PET calls against 22,195 DV calls. Even if every single shortlisted candidate cleared the PET, at most one in three could reach Document Verification. Most people preparing for this exam believe PET is the prize. It is a filter, and it is the second of four.

Part 2 takes that arithmetic apart properly, because it changes how you should spend the next ten weeks.

PART 2

Four gates, and the arithmetic nobody explains

What each stage actually tests, what it is worth, and how the shortlists are built.

The Level-1 recruitment is a single-stage Computer Based Test followed by three more stages. Every stage can end your candidature, but only one of them earns you marks. Understanding which is which is the difference between training smart and training hard in the wrong direction.

Stage	What it is	Nature	Shortlist built how
1. CBT	100 questions, 100 marks, 90 minutes	Merit. Marks decide everything	All eligible applicants sit it
2. PET	35 kg carry 100 m, then 1000 m run	Qualifying. Pass or fail only	Three times community-wise vacancies, by CBT merit
3. DV	Original documents checked against your claim	Qualifying, but fatal	One candidate per vacancy, by CBT merit among PET passers
4. ME	Railway medical examination	Qualifying, but fatal	Same candidates as DV

Gate 1: the CBT is the only place you gain anything

Everything downstream is pass or fail. Your rank in the final merit list is your CBT score, and nothing else. That is not a reason to ignore PET. It is a reason to stop treating PET as the thing you will start on once the exam is done.

Because the CBT decides both who goes to PET and who goes to DV, a candidate who scores two marks higher sits above you in both lists. Two marks on a 100-mark paper with a one-third penalty is roughly six questions. That is the real currency of this exam.

Gate 2: three times, and why that number is cruel

Shortlisting for the PET is done Railway-wise and community-wise at three times the notified vacancies. The board can raise or lower that ratio, but three is the working assumption. For 22,195 posts that is about 66,585 calls, spread across every RRB, community and category.

Then Document Verification is held at one candidate per vacancy. So the PET is not a step towards selection in any proportional sense. It is a cut that removes candidates the CBT already ranked, and it is administered as a pass or fail.

Here is the part candidates miss. If you clear the PET but sit below the DV cut in your RRB, you get nothing at all, and you will not be told why. There is no waiting list you can join by asking.

> Practical consequence: your PET training must be finished before the CBT result, not after. If you start running the week your shortlist appears, you have weeks, not months, and the cut is absolute.

Gate 3: Document Verification at one to one

The number called for DV equals the number of notified vacancies in your Railway. The order is CBT merit among those who cleared PET. This is the stage where a genuine rank holder loses a job for a certificate that was issued in the wrong format, or a caste certificate that expired, or a name that does not match the matriculation certificate.

Part 9 is the full file list. Read it before you apply, not after you are called, because several of those documents take four to eight weeks to obtain.

Gate 4: the medical examination

Physically fit in all respects, plus a specific visual acuity standard that depends on the post you opted for. Part 8 decodes all four standards. The short version: if you wear glasses beyond the permitted power, or you have had laser eye surgery, some posts are closed to you, and you need to know that before you fill in your post preferences, not after.

Normalisation, explained without jargon

The CBT runs in many shifts, and different shifts get different papers. Comparing raw marks across shifts is unfair, because one paper is always harder. So marks are normalised: your raw score is converted into a position relative to everyone who sat the same paper, and that position is what gets compared across shifts.

Three things follow. You cannot calculate your own normalised score, so do not try. A raw score that looks weak can normalise well if your shift was hard. And the one thing fully inside your control is your raw score, so that is where the effort goes.

The tie-break, and why it matters more than people think

When two candidates have the same marks, the older candidate is placed higher. If the ages are also the same, alphabetical order of the given name decides, and the given name, not the surname, is what counts.

In a recruitment with tens of thousands of candidates sitting on identical scores around the cut, ties decide real seats. You cannot influence this, but you should know it exists, because it explains why a friend with the same marks was called and you were not.

Two sentences that protect you from bad advice

Being called for the PET, or clearing it, or being called for DV, does not create any right to appointment. The CEN says this in plain words, and it means the board can call more people than there are posts without promising any of them a job.

The RRB only recommends names. The appointment letter comes from the Railway Administration, after the medical examination, verification of certificates and a character and antecedents check.

PART 3

Eligibility: five ways to be out before you start

The conditions that are checked on the closing date, and the ones that can disqualify you years later.

One: the qualification must already be in your hand

Level-1 posts need Class 10 pass, or an ITI, or an equivalent qualification, or a National Apprenticeship Certificate granted by NCVT. The CEN is blunt about timing: you must hold it on or before the closing date of applications, and candidates waiting for final results are not eligible.

This catches people every cycle. A result awaited, a certificate not yet printed, a marksheet held by the school, none of it counts. If your ITI result is due after the closing date, you cannot apply for that cycle.

Two: age is counted to a fixed date, not to the day you apply

The band is 18 to 33 years, reckoned as on 1 January of the recruitment year. For CEN 09/2025 the reference date was 1 January 2026. The date-of-birth window it produced is the clearest way to check yourself.

Category	Not born earlier than	Not born after
UR and EWS	2 January 1993	1 January 2008
OBC-Non Creamy Layer	2 January 1990	1 January 2008
SC and ST	2 January 1988	1 January 2008

The OBC-NCL and SC/ST dates already include the community age relaxation. Source: CEN 09/2025, para 5.1.

Three: the relaxation table, and the rule that stops you stacking it

Category	Relaxation in upper age limit
OBC-Non Creamy Layer	3 years
SC and ST	5 years
Ex-servicemen, at least 6 months service after attestation	UR and EWS 3 years, OBC-NCL 6, SC/ST 8, after deducting length of service
Persons with Benchmark Disabilities	UR and EWS 10 years, OBC-NCL 13, SC/ST 15
Serving Group C or erstwhile Group D railway staff and substitutes, 3 years service	Maximum age 40 for UR and EWS, 43 OBC-NCL, 45 SC/ST
Staff of railway canteens, co-operative societies and institutes	Length of service or 5 years, whichever is less
Widowed, divorced or judicially separated women, not remarried	Maximum age 35 for UR, 38 OBC-NCL, 40 SC/ST
Course Completed Act Apprentices trained in railway establishments	To the extent of apprenticeship, maximum 3, 6 or 8 years by community
Apprenticeship commenced before age 25	Maximum age 35 UR and EWS, 38 OBC-NCL, 40 SC/ST

Source: CEN 09/2025, para 5.2.

Two rules sit under that table and are frequently misunderstood. If you qualify for relaxation on more than one ground, you get the highest one, not the sum. And SC, ST and OBC-NCL candidates applying against an unreserved vacancy get no age relaxation at all, because the vacancy itself carries none.

Four: your date of birth is fixed for life

The date of birth you enter must match your matriculation or SSLC certificate exactly. No request to change it later will be considered, and any difference leads to disqualification. If your Class 10 certificate has a spelling variant of your name, resolve the mismatch now rather than at Document Verification.

Five: three categories that look alike and are not

EBC, EWS and OBC are three different things, and the CEN says so in capitals because candidates confuse them every year.

Category	What it gives you	How it is proved
OBC-Non Creamy Layer	Reservation in vacancies and 3 years age relaxation	Annexure II certificate plus Annexure II-A self-declaration
EWS	Reservation in vacancies, no age relaxation	Annexure III income and asset certificate
EBC	Fee concession only. No reservation, no age relaxation	Annexure III-A income certificate, or BPL card, or Izzat MST
Minority	Fee concession only	Annexure IV affidavit on stamp paper, produced at DV

Source: CEN 09/2025, paras 7.2, 7.3 and 8.1.

EBC means annual family income below Rs. 50,000, certified by a Revenue Officer up to Tahsildar level, a sitting MP for their constituency, or a Union Minister. An Extremely Backward Class certificate issued by a state government is not accepted in place of an EBC certificate.

> If you claim the EBC concession, your certificate must be dated on or before the closing date of applications. One issued afterwards is not accepted, and the candidature is liable to be rejected.

Nationality

Indian nationals, and the other categories of persons the CEN admits under para 4.0. If you hold a foreign passport or dual citizenship questions apply, read that paragraph in the live CEN rather than a summary, because the wording changes between cycles.

PART 4

Choosing your RRB: the one decision you cannot undo

One application, one Railway, no changes later. How to spend that single choice.

You submit one online application, through any RRB website, and it covers the whole recruitment. The CEN states that only one application is required and the portal will not entertain a second from the same candidate; the notification for the previous cycle went further and warned that multiple applications would lead to rejection of all of them and to debarment. Treat it as a one-shot form, because that is how it behaves.

Inside that single application you make two choices that follow you to the end: the RRB and Railway zone you are applying against, and the post categories you want within it. The CEN is explicit that the details entered while creating the account, and the chosen Railway, cannot be modified in the correction window afterwards.

What choosing an RRB actually means

Vacancies are notified Railway-wise and RRB-wise. Your CBT merit is compared against other candidates who chose the same RRB. PET shortlists are built Railway-wise. Document Verification is held at one per vacancy, Railway-wise. So you are not competing nationally. You are competing inside the pool you picked.

That has a direct consequence: the same raw score can be comfortably inside the cut in one RRB and outside it in another. Annexure B of the CEN is where the vacancy split lives, and it is the most useful table in the document for decision-making, more useful than the syllabus.

Four things to weigh, in order

- **Vacancies in the categories you are eligible for, in that RRB.** Not the total for the RRB. The total for your category. A large RRB with three vacancies in your category is a bad choice.
- **Your own category's share.** A reserved-category candidate should look at reserved vacancies in that RRB, because unreserved vacancies are competed for by everyone.
- **Where you can actually be present.** PET, DV and medical happen at the Railway's venues. Missing any of them for travel reasons ends the candidature, and requests to change venue, date or shift are not entertained under any circumstance.
- **Whether you would take the posting.** A Level-1 job means a specific railway, a specific division and a transfer liability. Choosing a zone you would refuse to join wastes the attempt.

Post preferences: opt wide, but honestly

You can indicate preferences across the post categories notified for your chosen Railway. Candidates with partial options are considered only for the categories they actually opted for. So opting for fewer posts narrows your chances to nothing more than the posts you named.

The counterweight is the medical standard. Each post carries one, and the standards are not equally forgiving. If you opt only for posts with the strictest standard and your eyes do not meet it, you can be found unfit with no alternative post to fall back on.

Post	Department	Medical standard
Pointsman B	Traffic	A-2, the strictest
Assistant Track Machine	Engineering, Track Machine	A-3
Trackmaintainer-IV	Engineering, P Way	B-1
Assistant P.Way	Engineering, P Way	B-1
Assistant Bridge	Engineering, Bridge	B-1
Assistant (S and T)	Signal and Telecom	B-1
Assistant TL and AC	Electrical, General Services	B-1
Assistant Operations (Electrical)	Electrical, General Services	B-1
Assistant TRD	Electrical, TRD	B-1

Source: CEN 09/2025, Annexure A. The CEN also notifies Assistant Loco Shed (Diesel and Electrical), Assistant C&W;, Assistant (Workshop), Assistant Works, Assistant Depot (Stores) and Hospital Assistant. Check the standard against your own category in the live CEN.

Note what that table implies. Pointsman B and Assistant Track Machine are closed to candidates who have had laser eye surgery. Every B-1 post is open to them, subject to conditions. If you have had surgery or wear a strong prescription, your preference list should lean B-1, and it should lean there deliberately.

A worked decision

Three candidates, same score band, three different right answers.

- **Candidate one** is 22, unreserved, wears glasses at minus 3.5 dioptres, no laser surgery, willing to work anywhere. Pointsman B is closed, because A-2 requires 6/9 both eyes without glasses. The right list is B-1 posts, opted wide, in the RRB with the largest B-1 vacancy count in their category.
- **Candidate two** is 31, OBC-NCL, has an ITI in electrical, cannot travel far for PET. Age relaxation gives three years, so the window is still open. The right list is a nearby RRB even if it has fewer posts, because a missed PET is a zero.
- **Candidate three** is 29, SC, has had LASIK. A-2 and A-3 posts are barred outright. B-1 posts are open, subject to the Railway Board conditions and the Annexure VII declaration. The right move is to opt B-1 only, and to keep the surgery record and the corneal thickness report ready for the medical.

> Read Annexure A and Annexure B of the live CEN before you fill the form. Not a coaching blog's summary of them. The preferences you lock in that evening are the ones that decide which medical standard you will be judged against a year later.

PART 5

The application: where avoidable rejections happen

The form itself, the fee and refund mechanics, and the ten things that get applications thrown out.

The application is short. The failure rate is not low. Almost all of it comes from four places: a mismatched date of birth, a fee paid but the form not submitted, an Aadhaar-linked bank account that does not work, and documents scanned to the wrong specification.

What you need before you open the site

- Your own mobile number and an active personal email address. Both are used for every message from the board for the next year, so they must stay live.
- Class 10 certificate and marksheet, ITI or NAC certificate if you are relying on one.
- Aadhaar, for identity and for the fee refund route.
- Caste, EWS, EBC or minority certificate as applicable, in the format the CEN prescribes.
- A recent photograph and signature, scanned to the dimensions the CEN specifies.
- A debit card, credit card, net banking or UPI, since the fee is accepted online only.

The steps, in order

1. Create an account on the application portal with your mobile number and email. The details you enter here cannot be modified later, so type them carefully.
2. Complete your profile with educational qualification and personal details. The CEN asks you to enter your highest qualification at registration and the qualification the category requires at application stage.
3. Capture a live photograph when the portal asks for it. This is a real-time capture, not an upload.
4. Choose your RRB and Railway, then your post preferences within it.
5. Pay the fee online. Complete this before the fee deadline, which falls after the application deadline.
6. Submit the application. Paying without submitting leaves you with no application and no refund.
7. Download and keep the submitted application printout. You will need it at Document Verification.

The fee, and the refund that people lose

Candidate category	Fee	Refunded if you appear in CBT
All candidates not listed below	Rs. 500	Rs. 400, less bank charges
SC, ST, Ex-servicemen, PwBD, women, transgender, minorities, EBC	Rs. 250	Rs. 250, less bank charges

Source: CEN 09/2025, para 7.0.

An unreserved candidate who actually sits the exam effectively pays Rs. 100. A woman, an SC or ST candidate, or an EBC candidate who sits it pays nothing. But the refund is not automatic, and this is where the money is lost.

The refund is credited only to a bank account seeded with your Aadhaar number. During the application you validate your Aadhaar, and the portal shows the bank account linked to it. If no account is linked, you are sent to the NPCI portal to link one in real time and then brought back. If you do not have an account, you can use a family member's Aadhaar-seeded account.

> The CEN puts the responsibility for a valid, operational, Aadhaar-seeded account entirely on you, and says it will not entertain claims arising from a wrong or non-operational account. Check the account before you pay, not after.

Three cases get no refund at all: an application that is incomplete or rejected, an application that was never submitted, and a candidate who does not appear for the CBT.

The correction window, and what it will not fix

A window opens after the application closes in which corrections can be made on payment of a modification fee, which is itself non-refundable. Two things are outside it: the details entered while creating the account, and the chosen Railway. Everything that matters most is therefore locked on day one.

Ten things that get applications rejected

1. A second application from the same candidate. The portal is built for one, and the previous cycle's notification warned that duplicates mean rejection of all and debarment.
2. A date of birth that does not match the matriculation certificate.
3. A qualification claimed but not held on the closing date, including a result awaited.
4. Fee paid but the application never submitted.
5. A scanned photograph or signature that does not meet the prescribed specification.
6. A caste or EWS certificate in a format other than the annexure the CEN prescribes.
7. An EBC certificate dated after the closing date.
8. A minority fee concession claimed without the Annexure IV affidavit at Document Verification.
9. Details in the create-account step that cannot be verified later, such as a dead mobile number or an email you do not control.
10. A name spelling that differs from the Class 10 certificate.

Notice that only two of those ten are about merit. The rest are administrative, and all of them are preventable in one careful evening.

A 90-minute application routine

Do the whole thing in one sitting, at a desk, with the documents spread out. Keep the printout. Photograph the screen at the submission confirmation. Then leave the portal alone for a day and log back in to confirm the application shows as submitted, because the single most expensive mistake in this list is paying and closing the browser.

PART 6

The CBT: 100 marks, 90 minutes, one section decides it

Pattern, the real maths of negative marking, and an eight-week plan built around time per question.

Section	Questions	Marks
General Intelligence and Reasoning	30	30
Mathematics	25	25

Section	Questions	Marks
General Science	25	25
General Awareness and Current Affairs	20	20
Total	100	100

Duration 90 minutes, extended to 120 for candidates eligible for a scribe. One third of a mark is deducted per wrong answer. Source: CEN 09/2025.

The section split is indicative, so the paper can vary slightly. The standard is Class 10, and the marking is one mark per question with a one-third penalty for a wrong answer.

The negative marking maths, worked properly

A one-third penalty sounds mild. It is not, once you look at the break-even.

Situation	Chance of being right	Expected marks
Four options, pure guess	1 in 4	0.25 minus 0.25 = 0.00
One option eliminated	1 in 3	0.33 minus 0.22 = +0.11
Two options eliminated	1 in 2	0.50 minus 0.17 = +0.33
Sure of the answer	1	1.00

Read the first row again. A blind guess is worth exactly zero, not negative. So there is no penalty for guessing at random beyond wasting the two seconds. The mistake candidates make is the opposite one: they eliminate two options, feel uncertain, and leave the question blank, when attempting it is worth a third of a mark in expectation.

The rule that follows is simple. Never leave a question blank if you have eliminated even one option. Never spend more than a few seconds on a question where you have eliminated nothing.

Qualifying marks are not your target

Category	Minimum qualifying percentage
UR and EWS	40 per cent
OBC-Non Creamy Layer	30 per cent
SC	30 per cent
ST	30 per cent

PwBD candidates may get a two-mark relaxation where there is a shortage against reserved vacancies.

Forty out of a hundred qualifies an unreserved candidate. It does not get anyone a job. In a recruitment where tens of thousands sit for twenty-two thousand posts, the cut sits far above the qualifying line, and it varies by RRB and by category. Train to beat your RRB's previous cut, not the qualifying threshold.

Time budget: 54 seconds a question

Ninety minutes for a hundred questions is fifty-four seconds each. Nobody finishes by spending fifty-four seconds on every question. You finish by spending twenty-five seconds on the ones you know and ninety on the ones that need work, and by abandoning the rest quickly.

Pass	Time	What happens
Pass 1	0 to 45 min	Answer everything you can do in under 40 seconds. Skip anything that needs setting up
Pass 2	45 to 75 min	Return to the skipped ones. Attempt any question where you have eliminated an option
Pass 3	75 to 90 min	Fill every remaining answer with your best elimination. No blanks

Section by section, and what to actually drill

General Intelligence and Reasoning, 30 questions. This is the largest section and the most trainable. Analogies, coding and decoding, number and letter series, syllogism, Venn diagrams, direction sense, blood relations, seating arrangement, statement and conclusion, mathematical operations, word arrangement. Practice improves this section faster than any other, which is why it deserves the biggest share of your study time.

Mathematics, 25 questions. Number system, BODMAS, decimals and fractions, LCM and HCF, ratio and proportion, percentage, average, profit and loss, simple and compound interest, time and work, time and distance, mensuration of two and three dimensional figures, elementary algebra, geometry, trigonometry and basic statistics. All of it Class 10 level. The trap is speed, not difficulty.

General Science, 25 questions. Physics, chemistry and biology to Class 10 standard. Units and measurement, motion, force, work and energy, light, sound, electricity and magnetism, heat. Acids, bases and salts, metals and non-metals, the periodic table, chemical reactions, carbon compounds. Cell structure, human body systems, nutrition and deficiency diseases, plant physiology, classification, and basic ecology.

General Awareness and Current Affairs, 20 questions. Current events of the last several months, sports, art and culture, persons in the news, economics and banking basics, Indian polity, and science and technology. This is the section candidates neglect and then lose four marks to.

An eight-week study plan

Week	Focus	Output to hit
1	Reasoning fundamentals plus a diagnostic mock	Baseline score recorded, error log started
2	Reasoning puzzles and syllogism. Maths: number system, ratio, percentage	Two timed sectional tests
3	Maths: profit and loss, interest, time and work	Two timed sectional tests, 25 questions in 22 min
4	Maths: mensuration, algebra, geometry. Science: physics	One full mock, error log reviewed
5	Science: chemistry and biology	Two sectional tests, science only
6	General awareness, current affairs, static polity and economy	Daily 20-question current affairs set
7	Full mocks, alternate days. Weak-area repair only	Three full mocks under 90 minutes
8	Revision of the error log, two full mocks, no new topics	Two full mocks, both above your target cut

What the questions actually look like

The paper is Class 10 standard, and the difficulty is in the clock rather than in the content. Six worked examples, one per question type that recurs, so you can calibrate what you are aiming at.

1. Number series, reasoning. 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ? The gaps are 4, 6, 8, 10, so the next gap is 12 and the answer is 42. Series questions are almost always about the gap between terms, or the gap between the gaps. Write both rows down before you look for a rule.

2. Coding, reasoning. If CAT is written as 24, then DOG is written as what? C is 3, A is 1, T is 20, and 3 + 1 + 20 = 24. So the code is the sum of alphabet positions. D is 4, O is 15, G is 7, and 4 + 15 + 7 = 26.

3. Time and work, mathematics. A finishes a job in 12 days and B in 18. Working together they finish it in how many days? In one day A does 1/12 and B does 1/18, so together 3/36 + 2/36 = 5/36 of the job. The job takes 36/5 = 7.2 days. Never average the two day-counts; add the rates.

4. Speed, mathematics. A train 240 metres long crosses a pole in 12 seconds. Its speed is 240 / 12 = 20 metres per second, and 20 x 3.6 = 72 kilometres per hour. The multiplier 3.6 is the single most useful conversion in this section.

5. Simple interest, mathematics. Rs. 8,000 at 7.5 per cent per annum for two years earns 8,000 x 0.075 x 2 = Rs. 1,200. If the question says compound interest, it is 8,000 x (1.075 squared minus 1) = Rs. 1,245. Read the word twice; that is where the mark goes.

6. Kinetic energy, general science. A body of mass 5 kg moves at 4 metres per second. Its kinetic energy is half of 5 times 4 squared, which is half of 80, so 40 joules. Learn the formula with its units attached and the arithmetic becomes trivial.

None of those six is hard. All six are lost routinely to misreading, to unit slips, or to spending ninety seconds on a question worth one mark. The practice is not about learning new mathematics. It is about making these six moves automatic so that the ninety minutes go to the twenty questions that actually separate candidates.

The error log is the whole method

Every wrong answer goes into a notebook with three columns: what the question was, why you got it wrong, and the rule that would have prevented it. Wrong answers fall into four types, and each has a different fix.

- **Knowledge gap.** You did not know the fact. Fix by revision, not practice.
- **Method gap.** You knew the topic but not the shortcut. Fix by drilling that question type in a block of ten.
- **Careless error.** You misread or miscalculated. Fix by marking keywords on the screen before solving.
- **Time error.** You spent four minutes on a two-mark question. Fix by practising abandonment, which is a skill and needs reps like any other.

Ten full mocks reviewed this way beat forty mocks taken and forgotten. The review is the training. The mock is only the measurement.

PART 7

The PET: exact standards and a ten-week fix

35 kg for 100 metres, then a kilometre. The gate most shortlisted candidates fail.

Test	Male candidates	Female candidates
Weight carrying	Lift and carry 35 kg for 100 m in 2 minutes, one chance, without putting it down	Lift and carry 20 kg for 100 m in 2 minutes, one chance, without putting it down
Running	1000 m in 4 minutes 15 seconds, one chance	1000 m in 5 minutes 40 seconds, one chance

Transgender candidates are tested to the female standards. Source: CEN 09/2025, para 14.2.

How the test actually runs

Two stages, in a fixed order. First the weight carrying. You lift a sandbag with no handle from a bench or platform at about waist height, and carry it to a point 100 metres away without letting it touch the ground. You may carry it however you like. You have one attempt and two minutes.

Only if you clear that do you get the running test, after a recovery gap. Failing the carry eliminates you at that stage and you are not allowed to run. That ordering is not a detail: it means the carry, which almost nobody trains for, is the real filter.

Why the sandbag is harder than the gym

Thirty-five kilograms is not heavy. A bag of cement is fifty. Three things make this test different from lifting a barbell.

- **No handle.** There is nothing to grip. Your forearms and fingers are doing work they never do in a gym, and grip fails before the legs do.
- **It shifts.** Sand moves. Every step the load repositions itself, so your trunk works continuously to stop it swinging.
- **The clock is generous, the distance is not.** One hundred metres in two minutes is a walk at under one metre per second. Speed is not the problem. Dropping it at the seventieth metre is.

Four ways to carry it, honestly compared

Carry	How	Best for	Risk
Shoulder	Bag on one shoulder, arm locked over it	Short carries, good grip relief	Slips on turns, one-sided load on the spine
Bear hug	Both arms under and around, against the chest	Most candidates, most stable	Crushing the breath if held too high
Suitcase	One arm at the side, bag against the thigh	Strong grip and forearms	Grip fails first, load pulls you sideways
Back carry	Bag on the upper back, arms over the shoulders	Long distance with good posture	Hard to load alone, hard to see your footing

For most candidates the bear hug wins, because it keeps the load centred over the feet and removes the balance problem. Practise two carries, not four. Pick your primary in week one and use it every session so the movement becomes automatic.

The 1000 metres, in splits

Four minutes fifteen seconds for a kilometre is 3.92 metres per second, about 14.1 kilometres per hour. It is a hard run for an untrained person and a comfortable one for anyone who has run for ten weeks. Here are the splits to hold.

Distance	Male target, 4:15	Female target, 5:40
200 m	51 seconds	68 seconds
400 m	1 minute 42	2 minutes 16
600 m	2 minutes 33	3 minutes 24
800 m	3 minutes 24	4 minutes 32
1000 m	4 minutes 15	5 minutes 40

The most common failure is going out too fast. A candidate who runs the first 200 metres in 38 seconds feels strong, then loses fifteen seconds in the last 300 and misses by five. Run the first 200 at target pace or slightly slower, hold the middle 600, and spend everything in the last 200.

The ten-week plan

This assumes you can walk briskly for thirty minutes today. If you cannot, spend the first three weeks walking before starting week one.

Week	Running	Carry	Strength
1	3 runs: 15 min easy, 20 min easy, 1 km time trial	4 x 40 m with 15 kg	Bodyweight squats, planks, dead hangs
2	3 runs: 20, 25, 25 min easy	4 x 60 m with 20 kg	Same plus lunges and farmer carries
3	Intervals: 6 x 200 m at target pace, 90 s rest	4 x 80 m with 25 kg	Goblet squats, rows, grip work
4	Intervals: 5 x 400 m at target pace, 2 min rest	4 x 100 m with 25 kg	Deadlifts or trap-bar if available
5	Intervals: 4 x 600 m, 2 min rest. One 1 km time trial	5 x 100 m with 30 kg	Same, add core anti-rotation
6	3 x 800 m at target pace, 3 min rest	4 x 100 m with 35 kg, full distance, timed	Reduce volume, keep intensity
7	1 km time trial at race pace. Two easy 20 min runs	3 x 100 m with 35 kg, timed	Maintenance only
8	6 x 200 m sharpening, then easy runs	2 x 100 m with 35 kg	Mobility, grip hangs
9	Taper: two 15 min easy runs, one 400 m at pace	1 x 100 m with 35 kg	Rest, sleep, no new work
10	Two 12 min easy runs, nothing else	One light 50 m carry, technique only	Rest

Progression rules that prevent injury

- Add load before you add distance, never both in the same week.

- The carry is trained at full body weight once a week from week six, and never more than twice a week at any load.
- Shin splints and knee pain come from running volume jumps. Do not increase weekly running distance by more than about ten per cent.
- Lower back pain on the carry means your trunk is giving way. Drop the load and fix the position before adding weight.
- If you feel a sharp pain, stop the session. Missing one session costs nothing. Missing the test costs a year.

If you have four weeks, not ten

Some readers are on a PET shortlist now. Four weeks is not enough to build fitness from nothing, and it is more than enough to convert an existing base into a pass. Be honest about which situation you are in.

Your current 1000 m	What four weeks can realistically do
Under 5:30	A 4:15 is reachable. Train structure, not volume
5:30 to 6:15	4:15 is a stretch and 5:40 is likely. Depends on your base and your body weight
Over 6:15	A pass in four weeks is unlikely without an existing running background. Train anyway, and treat this cycle as preparation for the next

The four-week version of the plan keeps the structure and cuts the volume. Four runs a week, not three. One interval session, one tempo run at target pace for 600 metres, one easy 20-minute run, and one time trial each week so you can see the trend. Two carry sessions a week, building 25 kg to 30 kg to 35 kg across the four weeks, with the final full-load session at least eight days before the test.

The rule that matters most in a short runway is this: do not add running volume and carry load in the same week. The injury that ends a four-week plan is almost always a shin or a lower back, and both come from doing too much in week two because week one felt easy.

This week, if you were shortlisted today

1. Read your admit card the day it appears and note the reporting time, the venue and the documents listed. Candidates reporting after 0600 hours without justification are not admitted.
2. Run 1000 metres tomorrow and time it honestly, on a flat surface, with a proper warm-up. That number decides everything about the next four weeks.
3. Find a 35 kg sandbag or a bag you can load to 35 kg with no handle, and carry it 100 metres. Most people discover on that first attempt that grip, not strength, is the problem.
4. Book a full eye test if you have not had one in the last year, because the medical standard for your post will be applied later and there is no point clearing the PET for a post you cannot be found fit for.
5. Sleep. The single largest predictor of a four-week improvement is not a training method, it is recovery.

The day itself

Report at the time on your admit card. Candidates reporting after 0600 hours without justification are not permitted to participate. Come clean shaven except where the notification exempts you, and carry the admit card in duplicate along with the documents the notice lists.

Eat a normal meal about three hours before, nothing heavy after. Wear shoes you have run in at least five times, not new ones. Warm up for ten minutes: easy jog, leg swings, ankle circles, two short strides. Before the carry, chalk or dry your hands if it is allowed, and grip the bag by the corners rather than the

middle.

> One chance means one chance. There is no second attempt at either stage and no appeal on the ground that you slipped. Train the carry until you can do 100 metres and still talk at the end of it.

Who does not take the PET

Candidates with benchmark disabilities as specified in the CEN are exempt, but must pass the medical examination prescribed for PwBD after qualifying in the CBT. Course Completed Act Apprentices are exempt. Ex-servicemen are exempt from the PET but must still pass the written test, any physical standards, and the medical standards prescribed for direct recruits.

PART 8

Medical standards: the gate that ends careers quietly

Four standards, one of which will be applied to you. Know which before you choose your posts.

Every post carries a medical standard, and the examination tests against that standard and no other. The standards differ mainly in how good your eyes must be, and whether they must be good without glasses.

Standard	Distant vision	Near vision	Other tests
A-2	6/9 and 6/9 without glasses, no fogging test	Sn 0.6 and 0.6 without glasses	Colour, binocular, night and mesopic vision
A-3	6/9 and 6/9 with or without glasses, lens power not above 2D	Sn 0.6 and 0.6 with or without glasses	Colour, binocular, night and mesopic vision
B-1	6/9 and 6/12 with or without glasses, lens power not above 4D	Sn 0.6 and 0.6 with or without glasses	Colour, binocular, night and mesopic vision
C-1	6/12 and 6/18 with or without glasses	Sn 0.6 and 0.6 with or without glasses	As specified for the post

All four require the candidate to be physically fit in all respects. Source: CEN 09/2025, para 3.0.

What those numbers mean in plain language

6/9 means that what a normal eye can read at nine metres, you must read at six. So 6/9 is slightly below perfect and perfectly ordinary. 6/12 and 6/18 are progressively more relaxed. Sn 0.6 is the near-vision equivalent, and it is what most people with reading glasses comfortably meet.

The phrase that changes everything is **without glasses**. A-2 requires 6/9 in both eyes with no correction at all. If you are myopic at minus 2, you do not meet A-2, and no amount of preparation fixes it. A-3 allows correction up to 2 dioptres. B-1 allows up to 4 dioptres. C-1 has no stated power limit, only a vision requirement.

The laser surgery rule, exactly as written

Candidates who have had LASIK or any other surgery to correct refractive error are not eligible for posts with medical standards A-2 and A-3 in this CEN. They are eligible for posts with standards B-1 and C-1, subject to the conditions in Railway Board letter 2022/H/5/1/NER/Dalbir dated 25 August 2022. A declaration in Annexure VII is submitted at Document Verification.

If you have had surgery, that single sentence should reorder your post preferences completely. Pointsman B is A-2. Assistant Track Machine is A-3. Both are closed to you. Trackmaintainer-IV, Assistant P.Way, Assistant Bridge, Assistant (S and T), Assistant TL and AC, Assistant Operations and Assistant TRD are all B-1, and all remain open.

> Do not treat this as a technicality to be argued at the medical. The board applies the standard as written, and there is no appeal route that turns an A-2 candidate with surgery into an eligible one.

The colour vision requirement is not decorative

A-2, A-3 and B-1 all require passing tests for colour vision, binocular vision, night vision and mesopic vision. Mesopic vision is what you use at dusk, and it is tested because railway work happens at night and in poor light. Candidates who have never been tested for colour vision should get an eye examination now, not at the railway hospital.

What physically fit in all respects covers

The CEN states that the standards listed are indicative and not exhaustive, and directs candidates to Chapter 5 of the Indian Railway Medical Manual, Volume I, published on the Indian Railways website. That chapter is the real rulebook, and it covers far more than eyes: general physique, hearing, blood pressure, chest measurement, hernia, flat foot, varicose veins, skin conditions and more.

You do not need to memorise it. You need to know it exists, so that when a doctor at the medical examination raises something, you understand that it is written down somewhere and not a personal judgement.

The thirty-day pre-check

Five things, all doable in a month, that catch most surprises early.

1. Get a full eye test with refraction. Write down your exact power in both eyes and compare it against the standard for your preferred post.
2. Get colour vision tested explicitly, not inferred from a general check-up.
3. Get blood pressure and blood sugar checked. Both are common grounds for temporary unfitness.
4. Get your hearing checked if you have any doubt, and get any chronic ear condition treated now.
5. Assemble your medical history: any surgery, any chronic condition, any medication. The medical examination asks, and an undisclosed condition found later is worse than a disclosed one.

If you fail the standard

The consequence is stated plainly in the standards note used in recent CENs: if you fail to pass the prescribed medical fitness standard for the post, you will not be considered for empanelment for that post, and no alternate appointment will be provided by the Railways. Some notifications give a candidate one final opportunity to opt for a post with a lower standard, where vacancies exist. Do not rely on it. Choose posts whose standard you actually meet, and verify that before you submit the form.

PART 9

Document Verification: the file that decides it

Originals, formats and the six things that lose a confirmed rank.

Document Verification is where your claim meets your paperwork. Candidates are called at one per vacancy, based on CBT merit among those who cleared the PET. If you are called, your rank is good enough. From that point the only thing that can remove you is a document problem.

The CEN is direct about the consequence: original certificates must be produced on the day, no additional time is given, and the candidature of a candidate who does not produce them is liable to be forfeited. There is no adjournment.

The file to carry

Document	Why it matters
E-call letter for DV	Entry to the venue. Download it from your RRB site under your login
Printout of the submitted application	Confirms what you claimed. Keep the one you saved on submission day
Matriculation or Class 10 certificate	The date of birth of record. Any mismatch is disqualifying
Class 10 marksheet, or ITI or NAC certificate	Proves the qualification for the post you opted for
Caste certificate, Annexure I format	For SC and ST claims. A state-format certificate may not be accepted
OBC-NCL certificate, Annexure II, plus Annexure II-A declaration	For OBC-NCL claims. Check the CEN's currency requirement for the certificate
EWS income and asset certificate, Annexure III	For EWS claims
EBC income certificate Annexure III-A, or BPL card, or Izzat MST	If you claimed the concessional fee
Minority affidavit, Annexure IV, on stamp paper	If you claimed the minority fee waiver
PwBD certificates, Annexure V (A) to (F) as applicable	For PwBD claims and scribe eligibility
Ex-servicemen declaration, Annexure VI or VI-A	For ex-servicemen claims
LASIK or refractive surgery declaration, Annexure VII	For posts with A-2 or A-3 standards, and for B-1 and C-1 where surgery applies
No Objection Certificate from your employer	If you are currently serving in government or a public sector organisation
Photo identity proof and Aadhaar	Identity verification at the counter
Passport photographs	Carry several, in the specification the CEN states

Carry two attested photocopies of everything, in a single folder, in the order above. The order is not for the clerk's benefit. It is so that you can find a document in ten seconds under pressure.

Six things that lose a confirmed rank at DV

1. A date of birth that differs by even a day from the matriculation certificate, or a name spelled differently.
2. An OBC-NCL certificate that is not in the prescribed format, or that does not meet the currency requirement in the CEN.
3. An EBC or minority claim without the supporting certificate or affidavit, which makes the fee concession itself a misrepresentation.
4. An EWS certificate in a format other than the annexure, or one that does not cover the required period.
5. No NOC, when you are a serving employee and the CEN requires one.
6. Claiming a PwBD, ex-serviceman or apprentice status you cannot prove. The CEN warns that fraudulent claims lead to disqualification and debarment from future RRB recruitments.

Start the slow documents now

A caste certificate, an EWS certificate and an income certificate can each take four to eight weeks, and the queue at a Tehsil office in a recruitment season is not short. If you are waiting for the next CEN, this is the most useful thing you can do this month, because it is the only part of the process you cannot compress later.

PART 10

After selection: pay, training and the real job

What Level 1 pays in November 2026, and what the posting actually involves.

Empanelment is not an appointment letter

The RRB verifies documents, checks the medical result and verifies antecedents, then recommends your name. The appointment is offered only by the Railway Administration. Between recommendation and joining there is a wait, and its length depends on the zone and the vacancy.

The pay

Level 1 of the 7th CPC pay matrix starts at an initial basic pay of Rs. 18,000 and runs to Rs. 56,900 at the top of the level. On top of basic pay come dearness allowance, house rent allowance and transport allowance as admissible, plus other allowances specific to the post and the place of posting.

Two things to keep straight when someone quotes you a monthly figure. Dearness allowance is revised periodically and is not a fixed number, so any gross salary you read online is a snapshot of a particular quarter. And the 8th Central Pay Commission is still working: it was constituted on 3 November 2025 with a report due around May 2027, and the government has said the usual ten-year cycle would suggest an effective date of 1 January 2026, without confirming that or any arrears. Until orders issue, the 7th CPC figures are the ones that apply.

What the work is, post by post

Trackmaintainer-IV is outdoor engineering work on the permanent way: inspecting, greasing, packing and replacing fittings, in all weather, often at night in traffic blocks. It is the largest single category and it is physical.

Pointsman B is traffic department work at stations: setting points, signals and shunting movements, in shifts, outdoors. It carries the strictest medical standard because the work is safety-critical and happens at night.

Assistant (S and T) works on signalling and telecom equipment, including relays, panels and cables. Assistant TL and AC works on electrical general services. Assistant TRD works on traction power distribution. Assistant Operations and Assistant Loco Shed roles sit around the running and maintenance of locomotives. Assistant Bridge and Assistant P.Way are engineering support roles.

Every one of them comes with a liability to be transferred anywhere within the railway, and in some cases anywhere in India, over a career. That is part of the bargain and it is worth being honest with yourself about before you opt.

Training and the first year

Selected candidates go through initial training at the zonal training centre or the relevant department's training institute, followed by on-the-job familiarisation. Safety training is mandatory for safety-category posts and is not a formality: it is examined.

A realistic five-year view

Promotion from Level 1 comes through departmental examinations and vacancy-based channels, and it is slower than in the graduate-level railway cadres. The people who move up fastest are the ones who clear departmental exams early, so the practical advice is unglamorous: join, learn the rule book, and start sitting departmental exams in your second year.

> None of this is a reason not to apply. A Level-1 railway job is a permanent central government post with pension-era benefits, medical cover for your family and job security that very little else in the private market matches at Class 10 qualification. It is simply not a desk job, and it is not in the city you choose.

PART 11

The next sixty days, for the 2026-27 cycle

What to do while the notification is still unpublished.

If you are waiting for the next Level-1 notification, you have an unusual advantage: time you will not have once it drops. Applications for the last cycle were open for thirty days. The CBT followed months later. The work that pays off is the work that cannot be done in thirty days.

Confirmed	Expected, not confirmed
Level-1 is in the Oct-Dec 2026 quarter of the Railway Board calendar	The exact notification date
Draft CEN was targeted for October 2026	The number of posts
Vacancies are counted up to 31 December 2027	The application window length
RRB Chandigarh is the nodal board for the category	The CBT month
Level-1 posts need Class 10, ITI or NAC; age 18 to 33	Whether the age reference date moves to 1 January 2027

The sixty-day plan

Days	What you do
1 to 7	Set up monitoring. Bookmark rrbapply.gov.in and your zonal RRB site. Start a folder for documents. Begin the running plan at week one
8 to 21	Apply for the slow certificates: caste, EWS, income, or a duplicate ITI or NAC certificate if yours is lost. These take weeks
8 to 30	Reasoning and maths fundamentals. Two hours a day, five days a week. Take one diagnostic mock and record the baseline
22 to 45	Add science and current affairs. Carry training begins at 15 kg. First full mock at the end of this block
46 to 60	Review the error log. Decide your RRB shortlist using the previous cycle's Annexure B as a guide to which zones carry your category. Two more full mocks

Build your own vacancy picture

The last CEN's Annexure B is the best available guide to where Level-1 vacancies sit, by Railway and by category. Download the CEN 09/2025 PDF from any RRB site, find the post category you are eligible for, and read the column for each Railway. It will not be identical this time, but the pattern is stable enough to be useful: the large engineering categories cluster in the big zonal railways, and the smaller technical categories are thin in most zones.

Monitoring that actually works

- Check rrbapply.gov.in and your zonal RRB's notice page twice a week, not twice a day. Nothing changes faster than that, and twice a day builds anxiety without information.
- Register your mobile and email carefully when the CEN opens, because every subsequent message comes there.
- Ignore any headline that says the notification is out unless it links to a PDF on an RRB domain. Aggregator sites publish speculative dates constantly and label them as news.
- Do not pay anyone for notification alerts. The official channels are free.

The one thing to start today

Run. Not because the PET is soon, but because the PET is the only stage where ten weeks of preparation converts directly into a pass, and the only stage where the timeline is outside your control. If the notification arrives in December and the CBT is in March, the PET falls in the middle of next year. A candidate who is already running 1000 metres in under five minutes in November has four months to find fifteen seconds. A candidate who starts in June has weeks.

PART 12

The scam surface, and how to stay off it

What the Railways never do, and what the people who call you will try.

Every cycle, candidates pay money to people who claim to have a route in. There is no route in. The CEN says selection is fair and transparent and on merit only, and that at no stage is any bribe to be paid for selection or recruitment.

The official surface is small

One application portal, rrbapply.gov.in, and the websites of the individual Railway Recruitment Boards, which the CEN lists in para 24.0. Your zonal board's site is where your e-call letter, city intimation and results appear. If a site is not one of those, it is not a source.

Six things that mark a scam

1. Anyone who asks for money to 'confirm' your selection, 'manage' your medical, or 'adjust' your marks.
2. Lookalike domains that copy the portal's design with a different spelling, and charge a fee to fill your form.
3. Telegram or WhatsApp groups selling 'leaked papers' or 'shift-wise questions'. There is no leak, and paying for one is paying for a fabrication.
4. Calls claiming to be from the RRB asking for an OTP, a card number or a fee to 'release' your result.
5. Agents who promise a particular Railway or division in exchange for a payment. The Railway is chosen by you in the form and cannot be changed afterwards, by anyone.
6. Any message that creates urgency: pay in the next two hours or lose the seat.

If you have already paid

Report it. The national cybercrime portal is cybercrime.gov.in and the financial fraud helpline is 1930. Report within twenty-four hours, because the faster a transaction is flagged the better the chance of a freeze. Keep screenshots, the payment reference and the phone number.

> The board also warns that candidates found using unfair means in the examination face action under the CEN's unfair practices provisions, and that fraudulent claims of category status lead to disqualification and debarment from future RRB recruitments. Debarment follows you to the next cycle, which is a far worse outcome than a failed attempt.

PART 13

Twelve questions, answered plainly

The ones that come up in every cycle, with the shortest honest answer.

Can I apply to two RRBs to improve my chances? No. One application covers the recruitment, and the Railway you choose is locked. Applying twice has led to rejection of both applications and debarment.

I missed the application window. Is there any way in? No. The window closes at 23:59 on the published date, and the fee deadline falls after it. The next opportunity is the next CEN, which is why Part 11 exists.

My ITI result is awaited. Can I apply? No. The qualification must be held on or before the closing date, and the CEN states that candidates waiting for final results are not eligible.

Can I change my chosen Railway after submitting? No. The chosen Railway cannot be modified in the correction window, and neither can the details entered while creating the account. Everything else has a short window.

I wear glasses. Which posts can I take? A-2 requires 6/9 in both eyes without glasses, so a myopic candidate cannot take Pointsman B. A-3 allows correction up to 2 dioptres, which covers a modest prescription. B-1 allows up to 4 dioptres and is the realistic route for most spectacle wearers.

I have had LASIK. Am I out? Not out, but narrowed. A-2 and A-3 posts are closed to you. B-1 and C-1 posts remain open subject to the Railway Board conditions, and you file an Annexure VII declaration at Document Verification.

Does clearing the PET improve my rank? No. The PET is qualifying. It removes people; it does not move anyone up. Your rank is your CBT score.

How many marks do I need? The qualifying floor is 40 per cent for unreserved and EWS candidates and 30 per cent for OBC-NCL, SC and ST. The cut that actually selects is far above that, and it differs by RRB and by category. Use your RRB's previous cycle cut as the target, not the qualifying line.

Is there a penalty for leaving questions unanswered? No. The one-third penalty applies only to wrong answers. But a blank question with one option eliminated is a third of a mark thrown away, so blanks should be rare.

What happens if I fail the medical examination? You are not empanelled for that post, and no alternate appointment is provided. Some notifications allow one final opportunity to opt for a post with a lower standard where vacancies exist. Do not plan around it: check the standard before you fill the form.

Will I be posted near my home? There is no such guarantee. You are recruited to a railway with a transfer liability, and postings follow the needs of the administration. The choice of Railway in the form is the closest thing to a preference you will get.

Will the 8th Pay Commission raise Level-1 pay before I join? Unknown. The commission was constituted on 3 November 2025 and has eighteen months to report, which puts the deadline around May 2027. The government has said the usual ten-year cycle would suggest an effective date of 1 January 2026, and has not confirmed that, any arrears, or any implementation date. Until orders issue, the 7th CPC figure of Rs. 18,000 initial basic pay is the one that applies.

WORKSHEETS

Worksheets

Six pages to print and write on. Fill them in by hand, date them, and keep them in one folder.

1. Eligibility self-check

Answer every line. Any 'no' is a reason to stop and fix it before you apply.

Check	Your answer	Pass?

2. RRB and post choice decision sheet

List three candidate RRBs. For each, record the vacancy count in your category from Annexure B, then the medical standard of every post you would opt for.

RRB / Railway	Vacancies in my category	Posts I will opt for	Standard met?

3. Application checklist

Tick each item on the evening you submit. Do not close the browser until the last tick.

Step	Done	Note

Step	Done	Note

4. CBT eight-week tracker

One row per week. Record mock scores, not hours studied, because hours are an input and scores are the output.

Week	Mock score	Weakest section	Fix planned	Done

5. PET ten-week log

Log every run and every carry. The column that matters is the 1000 m time, because that is the number the test measures.

Week	1000 m time	Carry load x distance	Sessions done	Notes

6. Document verification file

Tick when the original is in the folder and when two attested photocopies are behind it. Anything unticked is a risk you are carrying into the final stage.

Document	Original in folder	Two attested copies	Expiry or format checked

REFERENCE

Glossary

CEN	Centralised Employment Notice. The legal notification for a recruitment, published on RRB websites.
RRB	Railway Recruitment Board. The body that conducts the examination and recommends candidates.
RRC	Railway Recruitment Cell. The zonal body that runs recruitment for its railway.
CBT	Computer Based Test. The single-stage online examination that decides merit.
PET	Physical Efficiency Test. The weight carry and the 1000 m run. Qualifying only.
DV	Document Verification. Originals checked against your claims, at one candidate per vacancy.
ME	Medical Examination. Conducted by the Railway Administration against the post's medical standard.
Level 1	The lowest grade in the 7th CPC pay matrix used by the railways. Initial basic pay Rs. 18,000.
UR	Unreserved. Open vacancies that any eligible candidate may compete for.
EWS	Economically Weaker Section. Reservation category with an income and asset test, no age relaxation.
OBC-NCL	Other Backward Class, Non Creamy Layer. Reservation category with three years of age relaxation.
EBC	Economically Backward Class. Fee concession only, for annual family income below Rs. 50,000. Not a reservation.
PwBD	Person with Benchmark Disability. Exempt from PET, tested against a separate medical standard.
ExSM	Ex-Serviceman. Exempt from PET, still required to pass the written test and the medical.
CCAA	Course Completed Act Apprentice, trained in a railway establishment. Exempt from PET.
NAC	National Apprenticeship Certificate, granted by NCVT. Accepted in place of an ITI for these posts.
NCVT	National Council for Vocational Training. The body that issues the ITI and NAC certification.
IRMM	Indian Railway Medical Manual. Volume I, Chapter 5 is the real medical rulebook.
Normalisation	Conversion of raw marks into a comparable score across shifts, because different shifts get different papers.
Empanelment	Placement on the recommended list. Not an appointment. The Railway Administration issues the appointment.
Annexure	A prescribed format attached to the CEN. Certificates in the wrong format can be refused.
OIRMS	Online Indent and Recruitment Management System. Where railways record their vacancies.

PROVENANCE

Sources

Every factual claim in this book traces to one of the documents below. Nothing in it was taken from a coaching website, an aggregator or a social media post. Where a figure is an expectation rather than a published fact, the text says so.

1. CEN No. 09/2025, Recruitment for Various Posts in Level 1 of 7th CPC Pay Matrix

Government of India, Ministry of Railways, Railway Recruitment Boards. Published 30 January 2026. Hosted on the individual RRB domains, for example rrbcdg.gov.in and rrbchennai.gov.in. Source for eligibility, age limits and relaxation, fee and refund, medical standards, PET standards, shortlisting ratios, normalisation, tie-break rule, document requirements and the post-wise medical standards.

2. Frequently Asked Questions, CEN No. 09/2025

Railway Recruitment Board, Chandigarh, rrbcdg.gov.in. Source for application dates, fee concession categories and the refund policy.

3. Annual Recruitment Calendar 2026-27

Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, issued 12 December 2025 to all Railway Recruitment Boards. Source for the October to December 2026 quarter for Level-1 posts, the October 2026 draft CEN target, the 31 December 2027 vacancy assessment date and the nodal board.

4. Recruitment notices index

Railway Recruitment Board, Chandigarh, rrbcdg.gov.in/employment-notices.php. Consulted 13 November 2026 to confirm which CENs are published under the 2026 calendar.

5. Computer Based Test result and PET shortlist, CEN 09/2025

Declared by the Railway Recruitment Boards on 13 November 2026, zone-wise, for 22,195 Level-1 vacancies.

6. Indian Railway Medical Manual, Volume I, Chapter 5

Indian Railways, indianrailways.gov.in. The detailed medical fitness rules the CEN refers to.

7. Railway Board letter 2022/H/5/1/NER/Dalbir, dated 25 August 2022

Conditions under which candidates who have had LASIK or other refractive surgery are eligible for posts with medical standards B-1 and C-1.

8. Eighth Central Pay Commission

8cpc.gov.in. Constitution on 3 November 2025, the 18-month reporting window, and the status of implementation as of November 2026.

> This book is dated 13 November 2026. Recruitment rules change between cycles. Before you apply, download the live CEN from your RRB website and read paras 3.0, 5.0, 7.0, 14.0 and Annexure A against this book. If they differ, follow the CEN.

A closing note

Roughly one in three shortlisted candidates reaches Document Verification, and the number who lose a confirmed rank to a certificate problem is not small. Almost none of them lose it to a question they could not answer. They lose it to a form filled in a hurry, a certificate in the wrong format, a medical standard they did not check, or a run they did not train for.

All four of those are in your hands today. That is the whole reason this book exists.